

Land Planning Checklist

Task	Description	Influences	Notes / Responsible Party
Zoning Analysis	Determine existing zoning requirements (setbacks, height, impervious, FAR, building coverage, etc.) and any asks in a rezoning case.		Design based on Owner's direction (work at risk, assuming rezoning is granted, or work based on existing as-of-rights zoning)
Environmental Study	Required on sites with possible contamination issues, etc.		Owner Provided.
Geotech	Determine boring locations throughout site to get representative samples of different soils	Can impact buildability, foundations, etc.	Owner Provided. On sites with possible underground water or cave formations, this should be done early. Maps/civil can note where this is common.
Drainage/Flood Plains	Review Flood Plain locations and Critical Water Quality Zones. Determine general size and location of required detention ponds if applicable. Determine watershed requirements (if applicable) and how that may impact impervious coverage, irrigation fields required, etc.		Civil Provided. Determine Watershed on report, Locate flood plains and consult Fema Maps to confirm.
Trees	Determine tree locations and half critical root zones, and any special species (like Post Oak) that have unique requirements. Review Austin Tree Ordinance and mitigation requirements for projects with an SDP.		Owner Provided Tree Survey. Not required on SF-3, but owner responsible for arborist or other to locate any trees with root zones on site.
Tree Health	Determine health of trees with an Arborist		Owner Provided Tree Health Survey. Not required on SF-3, but owner responsible for noting any dead trees.
Trash	Determine serviceability of project through local municipality or private trash with dumpsters.	Locations/Size on site plan (private trash or dumpsters)	Owner to reach out to Municipality. If land plan looks like municipal trash may be difficult, provide alternates with dumpster locations.
Easements	Determine all easements on property, including drainage, electrical, gas/petroleum, etc., as all have their own sets of requirements.		Some easements, such as electrical power lines and petroleum easements, have 3-D components and construction rating impacts that should be noted.
Parking	Determine code required parking, if it exists. Add market rate assumptions as determined by Owner.	Yield and plan	Owner Provided market rate and guest parking needs.
Loading	Determine code required loading.	Yield and plan	Architecture Provided. Show recommended loading zone and make sure the site can handle truck maneuvering if required. Variances can be granted for truck circulation on street, but not always.
ROW Adjustments	Use city transportation code to determine if ROW might be requested.	Developable Site Area	Civil Provided.
Seller Agreements or Deed Restrictions	Determine if the seller has any agreements built into the contract that would impede or modify any future construction on site or if Deed Restrictions exist.	Varies	Owner Provided.
Topography	High sloping sites can impact vehicular access, drainage, and cost of foundations, as well as underground utilities (ie: underground waste water, etc., excessively deep to account for site slope)	Varies	Owner Provided topography survey. Civil engineer can determine any areas that may not be buildable due to high slopes.
Site Access	Determine if site would likely be allowed to have a single or multiple curb cuts. Locate access point at minimum distance from nearest intersections by transportation code.	Locations/Size on site plan	Note transportation code requirements and show min. distance.
FD Access	Determine if site would require FD access. Show hammer head or other methods for truck to get in and out of site. Show hose distance from furthest point of truck to furthest point of construction to confirm that concept will be approved by FD.	Unit layout and road layout will change based on FD access	Architecture and Civil provided. Note FD access area, highlight any Fire Lanes, and show hose pull.
Subchapter E - Commercial Design Standards	Review to see if the project falls under these standards during Zoning Analysis		
Subchapter E - Internal Circulation and 90 degree parking	Determine if site is over 5 acres, on certain roadways and will require Subchapter E internal circulation. This will impact project by adding sidewalks. Also, projects of this scale can fall into having 90 degree parking only, no one way roads, which can impact parking.		Show internal circulation and 90 degree parking based on Subchapter E if required. Subchapter E should be flagged regardless as it has the power to impact a great deal of the site. Other impacts begin at 3 acres. Maybe there's a "larger than 3 acre" trigger in the platform that causes this review.
Subchapter F - McMansion	Determine if these rules are applicable and show. It is not applicable to SF-3 2 and 3 unit projects, except for the definition of Gross Floor Area.		Show rules and restrictions
Neighborhood Plans	Determine if these rules are applicable and show.		Show rules and restrictions

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